come face-to-face with a problem that even Einstein couldn't solve. Shutting up never looked so good.

There's more at play here than a simple pragmatic desire to do physics or a clash between physics and philosophy. Ultimately, this is a story about people. "The case of the measurement problem," said David Albert, "was something very painful for the [physics] community. A lot of careers were destroyed. This whole business was a real trauma, in the psychological sense of the word, for physics." The history of quantum foundations is soaked in personalities. If David Bohm had held more palatable political convictions, if Hugh Everett hadn't hated public speaking, if Einstein had had Bohr's charisma, the story told in this book likely would have been dramatically different. So many of the key events were driven by political or social or interpersonal interactions, not by scientific considerations. This suggests another reason the Copenhagen interpretation is so popular: not because it is somehow better or more suited to the needs of physicists but simply because it was first.

From a naive perspective about science—from the view that science is merely a mechanism for deducing the One True Answer from the available clues, like a Sherlock Holmes story—this idea is disturbing. (Indeed, this whole book is probably disturbing to someone with such a view.) If these extraneous factors could have such a profound influence on fundamental physics, what part of science could possibly remain untouched? And, indeed, this isn't limited to quantum foundations: all of science is vulnerable to human biases and to influences from all the other spheres of human endeavor—politics, history, culture, economics, art—that some of those biases spring from. Most scientists, by and large, will agree to this. But agreeing with the abstract existence of these nonscientific biases within science is different from being faced with a concrete example. The idea that something as pervasive and central as the Copenhagen interpretation might be dominant for "accidental" nonscientific reasons can be scary, especially for people who have devoted their entire lives to physics. Once you give up Copenhagen, "there's more than one option on the table, and if there's more